

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 3: मित्राय नमः (Mitraya Namah)

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	3 — मित्राय नमः (Mitraya Namah)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: नमः/स्वाहा/स्वस्ति govern the DATIVE (चतुर्थी, -आय for a-stems, -ये for रवि), so मित्रः/सूर्यः (nominative) are wrong with नमः; सूर्यनमस्कारः is ONE compound (समास) where the first member drops its case ending, NOT the two words सूर्याय नमस्कारः; मित्र here is a Sun-name (not a friend or the moon); आचार्या (-आ) is female while आचार्यः (-ः) is male; there are exactly TWELVE Sun-names and TWELVE postures; and स्वस्थ = स्व + स्थ (self-abiding), glossed नीरोगम्. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A teacher says the Sun Salutation has twelve postures, each tied to one Sun-name, and the twelve Sun-names also mirror the twelve months. The deepest point this triple correspondence (postures = names = months) is meant to teach is that:

- (A) each month must be practised in a different posture or the benefit is lost
- (B) the Sun changes its actual name once every month
- (C) twelve is only a loose figure and the real count is closer to ten
- (D) the practice weaves body-movement, language and the cycle of the year into one daily discipline

2. The chapter lists the fruits of daily सूर्यनमस्कारः as a healthy body, वीर्यम्, तेजः and प्रज्ञा. Read as a whole, this list is best summarised as:

- (A) material wealth and social rank
- (B) freedom from all future study
- (C) all-round well-being — physical, energetic and mental
- (D) the same single benefit named four ways

3. Which statement about the structure of सूर्यनमस्कारः is FALSE?

- (A) It is made of twelve postures.
- (B) Each posture is joined to a Sun-name mantra.
- (C) The mantras are meaningless syllables chanted only for rhythm.
- (D) Daily practice is said to give a healthy body and mind.

4. A student counts only the postures done while facing forward and reports 'about half' of the salutation. Compared with the chapter's figure, this is wrong because the full सूर्यनमस्कारः has:

- (A) only six postures, so 'about half' is right
- (B) twelve postures in all, not six
- (C) ten postures
- (D) an unfixed number that varies daily

5. Why does the chapter teach grammar (the dative case) alongside the physical Sun Salutation, rather than in a separate lesson?

- (A) because the postures cannot be performed without first reciting case-endings
- (B) because the very first mantra मित्राय नमः already uses a dative, so the grammar is needed to understand what is being chanted
- (C) because the dative is the only case in Sanskrit
- (D) because grammar and exercise are unrelated and merely share a page

6. Parse मित्राय नमः into its two grammatical parts and their roles:

- (A) मित्राय = nominative subject, नमः = its verb 'salutes'
- (B) मित्राय = a compound, नमः = its case ending
- (C) मित्राय = vocative 'O friend', नमः = an adjective
- (D) मित्राय = dative ('to/for the Sun'), नमः = the indeclinable 'salutation' that governs it

7. In मित्राय नमः, treating मित्र as 'a (human) friend' produces a wrong reading because, in this chapter, मित्र is:

- (A) the name of the student's classmate
- (B) another word for the moon
- (C) one of the twelve names of the Sun
- (D) the name of a river

8. A pupil renders मित्राय नमः as 'the friend bows to me'. The single biggest grammatical error is that he has:

- (A) correctly identified मित्र as the moon
- (B) mistaken नमः for a noun in the dative
- (C) read नमः as a past-tense verb
- (D) treated the dative मित्राय as if it were the nominative subject

9. Which rewriting keeps the meaning 'salutation to the Sun' grammatically correct?

- (A) सूर्यः नमः
- (B) सूर्यम् नमः
- (C) सूर्याय नमः
- (D) सूर्येण नमः

10. मित्राय नमः is the first mantra of the salutation. Reasoning by the same pattern, the mantra that salutes the Sun under the name रवि must be:

- (A) रविः नमः
- (B) रविम् नमः
- (C) रवये नमः
- (D) रवेः नमः

- 11.** नमः is special among the words in the mantra because, unlike an ordinary noun, it:
- (A) is indeclinable and idiomatically forces the word it salutes into the dative
 (B) changes its own ending to match the Sun-name's case
 (C) is a finite verb meaning 'I bow' (D) must always stand first in the sentence
- 12.** A student writes नमः चन्द्राय, नमः सूर्यः and नमः गुरवे, thinking he is being consistent. Which of the three is the WRONG form?
- (A) नमः चन्द्राय (B) नमः गुरवे
 (C) नमः सूर्यः (D) all three are correct
- 13.** The dative of an अ-stem like मित्र is मित्राय and of छात्र is छात्राय. By the same rule, the correct नमः-form for भास्कर (a Sun-name) is:
- (A) भास्करः नमः (B) भास्क्रेण नमः
 (C) भास्कराय नमः (D) भास्करस्य नमः
- 14.** The dative answers 'to/for whom?'. In सूर्याय नमः the dative सूर्याय therefore tells us:
- (A) by whom the salutation is made (B) to whom the salutation is offered — the Sun
 (C) from whom the salutation comes (D) whose salutation it is (the Sun's own)
- 15.** Choose the line in which नमः and its object are BOTH correct: namely नमः governs the dative AND the form given is a true dative.
- (A) मित्राय नमः (B) मित्रस्य नमः
 (C) मित्रम् नमः (D) मित्रेण नमः
- 16.** Why is मित्रः नमः grammatically defective while मित्राय नमः is correct?
- (A) मित्रः is a verb, and नमः needs a noun (B) मित्रः is plural, and नमः needs the singular
 (C) both are equally correct; the choice is only stylistic
 (D) मित्रः is nominative, but नमः requires its object in the dative (मित्राय)
- 17.** Extending the नमः-rule to a new sentence, the correct Sanskrit for 'salutation to the teacher (m.)' would be:
- (A) आचार्याय नमः (B) आचार्यः नमः
 (C) आचार्यम् नमः (D) आचार्या नमः
- 18.** रविः, भानुः, आदित्यः, अर्कः and भास्करः are listed together in the chapter. The grammatical-semantic relationship among them is that they are:
- (A) एकवचनशब्दाः — different words sharing one meaning (the Sun)
 (B) antonyms — opposite in meaning (C) a single compound split into parts
 (D) forms of one word in five different cases
- 19.** In a list of Sun-names — सविता, पूषा, मित्रः, हिमालयः, आदित्यः — exactly one does NOT belong. It is:
- (A) सविता (B) मित्रः
 (C) हिमालयः (D) आदित्यः

20. A quiz gives four glosses. Which pairs a Sun-name with the WRONG meaning?

- (A) रत्नाकरः = the Sun (B) भास्करः = the Sun
(C) आदित्यः = the Sun (D) मित्रः = the Sun

21. The chapter pairs twelve Sun-names with twelve postures one-to-one. If a thirteenth posture were invented, the design would break because:

- (A) thirteen is an unlucky number forbidden in Sanskrit
(B) there are only twelve Sun-names to pair with, leaving the extra posture with no name
(C) the Sun would gain a new name automatically
(D) the months would have to be increased to thirteen as well

22. Knowing that मित्र, सविता and पूषा are all the Sun, the best reason a single object (the Sun) has so many names in this chapter is to:

- (A) describe twelve different suns in the sky
(B) show that Sanskrit lacks a fixed word for the Sun
(C) let each of the twelve postures be saluted with a distinct yet equivalent name
(D) prove the names contradict one another

23. From the list आदित्यः, अर्कः, घटः, भानुः, which word is the odd one out and why?

- (A) आदित्यः — it alone is feminine (B) अर्कः — it alone is a compound
(C) भानुः — it alone means the moon
(D) घटः — it means 'pot', the rest are Sun-names

24. स्वस्थ literally splits into स्व + स्थ. The literal sense of these two parts is:

- (A) 'sun' + 'salute' = sun-salute (B) 'six' + 'fault' = six faults
(C) 'to' + 'for' = the dative idea (D) 'self' + 'standing/abiding' = self-abiding

25. स्वस्थम् is glossed in the chapter as नीरोगम्. This gloss confirms that स्वस्थ here means:

- (A) very wealthy (B) free from disease, i.e. healthy
(C) standing upright in a posture (D) self-centred and selfish

26. Why is 'self-abiding' (स्वस्थ) a fitting word for 'healthy', deeper than just 'not ill'?

- (A) because a healthy person never has to stand up
(B) because true health is being settled and at ease within oneself, not merely the absence of disease
(C) because health means depending entirely on others
(D) because स्वस्थ actually has nothing to do with the self

27. The chapter says the practice yields स्वस्थं शरीरम् AND स्वस्थं मनः. The pairing of these two phrases makes the point that सूर्यनमस्कारः benefits:

- (A) both the body and the mind
(B) only the body, the mind being mentioned by mistake

- (C) only the mind, the body being symbolic
(D) the wallet and the body, but not the mind

28. In स्वस्थं शरीरम् and स्वस्थं मनः the adjective स्वस्थम् appears in the same form before both nouns. The simplest reason is that:

- (A) स्वस्थम् never changes its form for any noun
(B) शरीरम् and मनः are both neuter, so the adjective स्वस्थम् agrees in neuter for both
(C) मनः is borrowing the form belonging to शरीरम्
(D) the two phrases are actually one compound word

29. If स्वस्थम् = नीरोगम् = healthy, then its opposite, describing a body that is ill, would most naturally be:

- (A) नीरोगम् itself (B) स्वस्थम् itself
(C) रोगयुक्तम् / सरोगम् (diseased) (D) तेजः

30. Match the benefit to its correct meaning: प्रज्ञा, तेजः, वीर्यम्. The CORRECT set of glosses is:

- (A) प्रज्ञा = vigour, तेजः = wisdom, वीर्यम् = radiance
(B) प्रज्ञा = wisdom, तेजः = radiance, वीर्यम् = vigour
(C) प्रज्ञा = radiance, तेजः = vigour, वीर्यम् = wisdom
(D) प्रज्ञा = wisdom, तेजः = vigour, वीर्यम् = radiance

31. A summary reads: 'सूर्यनमस्कारः removes आलस्यम् and भयम् and grants प्रज्ञा.' Which single original benefit-word best opposes आलस्यम् (laziness)?

- (A) प्रज्ञा (wisdom) (B) नीरोगम् (disease-free)
(C) नमः (salutation) (D) वीर्यम् (vigour)

32. Which benefit-to-effect mapping is INCORRECT?

- (A) तेजः → makes one sleepy and idle (B) प्रज्ञा → makes one wise
(C) वीर्यम् → makes one vigorous (D) स्वस्थं शरीरम् → keeps the body healthy

33. The chapter's four fruits describe a model person. A pupil who is bright in study, energetic in play, glowing with health and free of illness embodies, in order, which words?

- (A) वीर्यम्, प्रज्ञा, स्वस्थम्, तेजः (B) तेजः, स्वस्थम्, प्रज्ञा, वीर्यम्
(C) स्वस्थम्, तेजः, वीर्यम्, प्रज्ञा (D) प्रज्ञा, वीर्यम्, तेजः, स्वस्थं शरीरम्

34. From वीर्यं तेजः च प्रज्ञां च (vigour, radiance and wisdom), one quality is conspicuously NOT in the benefit-list of the chapter, namely:

- (A) प्रज्ञा (wisdom) (B) तेजः (radiance)
(C) धनम् (wealth) (D) वीर्यम् (vigour)

35. तेजः and वीर्यम् are easily confused. The cleanest one-line distinction the chapter supports is:

- (A) तेजः is wisdom, वीर्यम् is wealth (B) तेजः is fear, वीर्यम् is laziness
(C) they mean exactly the same thing
(D) तेजः is one's shining radiance, वीर्यम् is one's active strength/vigour

36. सूर्यनमस्कारः is described as a समास. The defining feature that makes it a compound rather than a phrase is that:

- (A) the two words are simply written next to each other with both endings kept
(B) two words are fused into one, and the first member सूर्य drops its case ending
(C) it is a finite verb formed from सूर्य and नमस्कार
(D) it is a full sentence with a subject and predicate

37. Inside the compound सूर्यनमस्कारः, the case ending -ः at the end belongs to:

- (A) the whole compound (carried by the final member नमस्कार), not to सूर्य
(B) the first member सूर्य, which keeps its own ending
(C) both members independently (D) a hidden verb inside the compound

38. Expanded into two separate words, सूर्यनमस्कारः ('Sun-salutation') becomes सूर्याय नमस्कारः. The case of सूर्याय there is dative because:

- (A) the first word of any phrase is always dative (B) नमस्कार, like नमः, governs the dative
(C) नमस्कारः itself is in the dative and सूर्याय copies it
(D) the dative is the only case Sanskrit allows after a noun

39. How does the compound सूर्यनमस्कारः differ in meaning/use from the two-word phrase सूर्याय नमस्कारः?

- (A) the compound names the whole practice (a thing), while the two words state the act 'salutation to the Sun'
(B) they are identical in every respect
(C) the compound is wrong Sanskrit and only the phrase is correct
(D) the phrase is the practice and the compound is the act

40. A pupil writes the compound as सूर्यायनमस्कारः, keeping सूर्य's dative ending inside it. The mistake is that:

- (A) a compound's first member must drop its case ending, giving सूर्यनमस्कारः
(B) the compound should keep every member's ending
(C) compounds are not allowed in Sanskrit at all
(D) the ending should move to the front of the word

41. Reasoning from the same compounding rule, 'salutation to Ravi' written as ONE compound word would be:

- (A) रवयेनमस्कारः (B) रविनमस्कारः
(C) रविःनमस्कारः (D) रवेःनमस्कारः

42. आचार्या and आचार्यः differ by a single final sound. The grammatical contrast they show is:

- (A) singular (-आ) vs plural (-ः) (B) dative (-आ) vs nominative (-ः)
(C) feminine (-आ) vs masculine (-ः) — a female vs a male teacher
(D) verb (-आ) vs noun (-ः)

43. The chapter's dialogue uses आचार्या throughout. A reader can therefore infer that the teacher in the dialogue is:

- (A) a woman (B) a man
(C) a group of teachers (D) a student, not a teacher

44. If an editor changed every आचार्या in the dialogue to आचार्यः, the single change to the story would be that:

- (A) the teacher would become plural
(B) the teacher would now be read as male instead of female
(C) the dialogue would turn into a list of mantras
(D) nothing at all would change

45. Given आचार्या = female teacher and आचार्यः = male teacher, the नमः-salutation 'to the female teacher' is correctly:

- (A) आचार्याय नमः (B) आचार्या नमः
(C) आचार्याम् नमः (D) आचार्यायै नमः

46. Besides नमः, the chapter notes that स्वाहा and स्वस्ति also govern the dative. The common thread is that these words:

- (A) are all finite verbs of the same root
(B) always cause the following word to drop its ending
(C) are interchangeable in meaning with one another
(D) form a small idiomatic set whose object regularly stands in the dative

47. By analogy with मित्राय नमः, the blessing 'well-being to the people' using स्वस्ति would be:

- (A) स्वस्ति प्रजाः (B) स्वस्ति प्रजाभ्यः
(C) स्वस्ति प्रजानाम् (D) स्वस्ति प्रजाभिः

48. स्वाहा is used in offerings, as in अग्नये स्वाहा. The form अग्नये is there because:

- (A) अग्नये is the nominative of अग्नि (B) स्वाहा is itself a dative that अग्नि copies
(C) स्वाहा governs the dative, and अग्नये is the dative of अग्नि
(D) the offering word always uses the accusative

49. Both मित्राय and छात्राय end in -आय, while रवये ends in -ये. The reason for the different endings, though both are datives, is that:

- (A) मित्र and छात्र are अ-stems (dative -आय) while रवि is an इ-stem (dative -ये)
(B) रवये is not really a dative, only -आय is (C) the three words are in three different cases
(D) -ये is a misprint and should also be -आय

50. The dative singular forms मित्राय, छात्राय and सूर्याय share the ending -आय. From this pattern, the dative singular of देव ('god') must be:

- (A) देवः (B) देवेन
(C) देवस्य (D) देवाय

51. Why does the chapter drill the paradigm of छात्र (छात्रः, छात्रम्, छात्रेण, छात्राय ...) before the mantras rather than after?

- (A) because छात्र is itself one of the Sun's names
(B) because the mantras are written in the छात्र paradigm
(C) so the student recognises -आय as the dative and understands why मित्राय (not मित्रः) follows नमः
(D) because only छात्र can be saluted with नमः

52. A pupil reasons: 'मित्राय ends in -आय; आय means "come"; so मित्राय नमः means "come and bow".' The flaw is that:

- (A) -आय here is the dative ending, not the verb 'come'; मित्राय is simply 'to the Sun'
(B) आय really does mean 'come', so the reading is right
(C) मित्राय is a verb meaning 'to bow' (D) नमः is the one that means 'come'

53. Identify the ONE fully correct statement.

- (A) नमः governs the nominative, so मित्रः follows it, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is two words.
(B) नमः governs the dative, so मित्राय (-आय) follows it, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is a single compound.
(C) नमः governs the dative, but सूर्यनमस्कारः is two separate words सूर्याय नमस्कारः.
(D) नमः governs the accusative मित्रम्, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is a compound.

54. Which pair is matched CORRECTLY?

- (A) समास = two words kept separate (B) चतुर्थी विभक्ति = the 'from' case
(C) आचार्या = a male teacher
(D) एकार्थकशब्दाः = words with one meaning (synonyms)

55. A pupil claims सूर्याय नमः and सूर्यनमस्कारः 'must mean different suns'. The correct response is:

- (A) both concern the same Sun; one is the act of saluting it, the other the name of the practice
(B) yes, the first sun is real and the second is imaginary
(C) yes, the compound refers to many suns at once
(D) no — both are simply ungrammatical

56. Putting the whole chapter together, सूर्यनमस्कारः is best described as:

- (A) a single mantra repeated twelve times, unrelated to grammar
(B) a moon-worship ritual that brings only wealth

(C) a wise saying about pots and water

(D) a twelve-posture practice, each posture chanted with a Sun-name in the dative after नमः, bringing health, vigour, radiance and wisdom

57. The chapter joins physical postures with grammatically-meaningful mantras. The underlying educational idea is that:

(A) grammar should be kept strictly separate from any activity

(B) movement makes the meaning of words irrelevant

(C) body and language can be trained together, so health and learning grow side by side

(D) only the body matters and the mantras are decorative

58. Three independent errors in one sentence: 'नमः takes the nominative, मित्र is the moon, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is two words.' The fully corrected version is:

(A) नमः takes the dative, मित्र is the moon, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is two words

(B) नमः takes the nominative, मित्र is a Sun-name, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is one compound

(C) the sentence is already fully correct

(D) नमः takes the dative (मित्राय), मित्र is a Sun-name, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is one compound

59. A student designs a new mantra for the Sun-name आदित्य and another for भानु. Using the नमः-rule, the correctly cased pair is:

(A) आदित्यः नमः and भानुः नमः

(B) आदित्याय नमः and भानवे नमः

(C) आदित्यम् नमः and भानुम् नमः

(D) आदित्याय नमः and भानुः नमः

60. Final synthesis: which chain of reasoning correctly explains मित्राय नमः from start to finish?

(A) नमः means 'salutation' and governs the dative → the Sun-name मित्र takes the dative मित्राय → so the phrase means 'salutation to the Sun (Mitra)'

(B) मित्राय is the subject doing the action → नमः is its verb → 'the friend bows'

(C) मित्राय नमः is a single compound → so it names a practice, like सूर्यनमस्कारः

(D) मित्र is the moon → मित्राय is instrumental 'by the moon' → 'worshipped by the moon'

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 3: मित्राय नमः (Mitraya Namah) — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	A	21	B	31	D	41	B	51	C
2	C	12	C	22	C	32	A	42	C	52	A
3	C	13	C	23	D	33	D	43	A	53	B
4	B	14	B	24	D	34	C	44	B	54	D
5	B	15	A	25	B	35	D	45	D	55	A
6	D	16	D	26	B	36	B	46	D	56	D
7	C	17	A	27	A	37	A	47	B	57	C
8	D	18	A	28	B	38	B	48	C	58	D
9	C	19	C	29	C	39	A	49	A	59	B
10	C	20	A	30	B	40	A	50	D	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (D) The chapter pairs twelve postures one-to-one with twelve Sun-names, and the twelve names echo the twelve months; the intended lesson is that physical practice, the Sanskrit names/mantras, and the natural year are unified into one daily routine. The Sun's name does not literally change each month — the twelve names are synonyms used together. The number is exactly twelve, not a loose 'about ten'. And one need not switch postures by month — every full cycle uses all twelve.

2. (C) स्वस्थं शरीरम् is physical, वीर्यम् (vigour) and तेजः (radiance) are energetic, and प्रज्ञा (wisdom) is mental — together an all-round well-being. Wealth and rank are nowhere claimed. The chapter never says one stops studying — प्रज्ञा is the fruit of, not a replacement for, learning. And the four are genuinely distinct fruits, not four labels for one thing.

3. (C) The false claim is that the mantras are meaningless — each is a salutation to the Sun by one of its meaningful names (e.g. मित्राय नमः). The other three are all true: twelve postures, each with a Sun-name mantra, and the practice yields a healthy body and mind.

4. (B) The chapter fixes the count at twelve postures, so 'about half' (six) undercounts. It is not six, not ten, and not a number that varies day to day; the twelve is fixed and matches the twelve Sun-names.

5. (B) मित्राय is a dative governed by नमः; explaining the dative right there lets the student understand the mantra being chanted, tying language to the practice. Postures do not require reciting endings first. The dative is one of several cases, not the only one. And the pairing is deliberate, not accidental shared space.

6. (D) नमः ('salutation') idiomatically takes its object in the dative, so मित्राय is 'to the Sun' and the phrase means 'salutation to the Sun'. It is not a nominative subject with a verb — नमः is an indeclinable, not a finite verb. मित्राय is a single word, not a compound. And it is dative, not vocative — a vocative would be मित्र.

7. (C) Here मित्र is used as a Sun-name (its sense 'friend' lies behind the name, but the referent is the Sun). It is not a classmate, not the moon, and not a river — those would all break the Sun-Salutation context.

8. (D) मित्राय is dative ('to the Sun'), governed by नमः; making 'the friend' the subject wrongly treats a dative as a nominative — the salutation is offered TO the Sun, not BY a friend. He did not (and should not) read मित्र as the moon, नमः is the salutation word that governs the dative, and the error is the case of मित्राय, not a tense on नमः.

9. (C) नमः governs the dative, so the Sun must be सूर्याय (dative). सूर्यः is nominative, सूर्यम् accusative, and सूर्येण instrumental — none of these is the case नमः requires.

10. (C) नमः needs the dative; the dative of the i-stem रवि is रवये, giving रवये नमः. रविः is nominative, रविम् accusative, and रवेः genitive/ablative — wrong cases after नमः.

11. (A) नमः is an indeclinable (अव्यय) that governs the dative — hence मित्राय, सूर्याय, रवये. It does not itself decline to match the noun, it is not a finite verb, and its position is free (मित्राय नमः or नमः मित्राय).

12. (C) नमः needs the dative. चन्द्राय (a-stem dative) and गुरवे (u-stem dative of गुरु) are correct datives, but सूर्यः is nominative — it should be सूर्याय. So नमः सूर्यः is the wrong one; the other two follow the rule and 'all three correct' is false.

13. (C) भास्कर is an अ-stem, so its dative singular is भास्कराय, matching मित्राय/छात्राय. भास्करः is nominative, भास्करेण instrumental, and भास्करस्य genitive — none works after नमः.

14. (B) The dative (चतुर्थी, 'to/for') marks the recipient: the salutation is offered to the Sun. 'By whom' would be instrumental (सूर्येण), 'from whom' ablative (सूर्यात्), and 'whose' genitive (सूर्यस्य) — different cases with different roles.

15. (A) मित्राय is the dative singular of मित्र — exactly what नमः requires. मित्रस्य is genitive, मित्रम् accusative, and मित्रेण instrumental; though each is a real form, none is the dative नमः governs.

16. (D) नमः governs the dative, so the saluted Sun must be मित्राय; मित्रः is the nominative and is therefore wrong. मित्रः is a noun (not a verb), it is singular (not plural), and the difference is grammatical, not merely stylistic.

17. (A) The male teacher आचार्य is an अ-stem; its dative singular is आचार्याय, which नमः requires. आचार्यः is nominative, आचार्यम् accusative, and आचार्या is the feminine nominative ('female teacher') — not the dative needed here.

18. (A) They are synonyms (एकार्थकशब्दाः) — distinct words all naming the Sun. They are not antonyms (not opposites), not pieces of one compound, and not five case-forms of a single word (each is its own word).

19. (C) हिमालयः is the mountain (the Himalaya), not a Sun-name. सविता, मित्रः and आदित्यः are all among the twelve names of the Sun.

20. (A) रत्नाकरः ('mine of jewels') is the ocean, not the Sun, so that pairing is wrong. भास्करः, आदित्यः and मित्रः are all genuine Sun-names correctly glossed as the Sun.

21. (B) The one-to-one scheme rests on exactly twelve names matching exactly twelve postures and twelve months; a thirteenth posture has no name to match. Sanskrit has no rule against the number thirteen, no new Sun-name appears on demand, and the year still has twelve months — so the surplus posture simply breaks the pairing.

22. (C) The many synonyms supply a distinct name for each of the twelve postures while all meaning the one Sun. There is only one Sun (not twelve), Sanskrit is not short of a word (it is rich in them), and synonyms agree rather than contradict.

23. (D) घटः is a pot, breaking the set of Sun-names आदित्यः, अर्कः, भानुः. आदित्यः is not feminine, अर्कः is not a compound, and भानुः is a Sun-name (not the moon) — so those three belong together.

24. (D) स्व = 'self/one's own' and स्थ = 'standing/abiding', so स्वस्थ is 'self-abiding'. The other splits invent meanings: स्वस्थ is not 'sun+salute', not 'six+fault', and not the dative gloss.

25. (B) नीरोगम् = 'disease-free', so स्वस्थ here means healthy. It is not 'wealthy', not merely 'standing' (that misreads the स्थ part literally), and not 'selfish' — 'self-abiding' means centred and at ease, the opposite of disturbed.

26. (B) स्व + स्थ pictures health as being centred and at ease in oneself — a positive state, richer than the bare ग्लोस नीरोगम्. It is not about literally standing, not about dependence

(the word stresses self), and the स्व ('self') is exactly the point.

27. (A) स्वस्थं शरीरम् (healthy body) plus स्वस्थं मनः (healthy mind) explicitly couples physical and mental health. It is not body-only or mind-only — both are named — and wealth (धनम्) is not in the pair.

28. (B) शरीरम् and मनः are both neuter nouns, so the agreeing adjective takes the same neuter form स्वस्थम् in each phrase. An adjective does change with gender/case in general (so 'never changes' is false), मनः is not borrowing anything, and they are two separate phrases, not one compound.

29. (C) नी-रोग means 'without disease'; its opposite must mean 'with disease' (सरोगम्/रोगयुक्तम्). नीरोगम् and स्वस्थम् are synonyms for 'healthy' (not opposites), and तेजः ('radiance') is unrelated to the contrast of healthy vs diseased.

30. (B) प्रज्ञा is wisdom, तेजः is radiance/brilliance, and वीर्यम् is vigour/valour. The other sets swap these around — e.g. calling तेजः 'vigour' or वीर्यम् 'radiance' mixes up the pair तेजः↔वीर्यम्, and the first option scrambles all three.

31. (D) वीर्यम् ('vigour/valour') is the natural opposite of आलस्यम् ('laziness'). प्रज्ञा opposes ignorance, not laziness; नीरोगम् opposes disease; and नमः ('salutation') is not a benefit-word at all.

32. (A) तेजः is radiance/brilliance; it does not bring sleepiness or idleness — that is the opposite of what the practice gives. The other three map correctly: प्रज्ञा→wisdom, वीर्यम्→vigour, healthy body→good health.

33. (D) Bright in study = प्रज्ञा (wisdom); energetic in play = वीर्यम् (vigour); glowing = तेजः (radiance); free of illness = स्वस्थं शरीरम् (healthy body). Only the first option keeps that exact order; the others mis-sequence the four.

34. (C) धनम् ('wealth') is never listed among the fruits of the practice — the benefits are bodily and mental, not material. प्रज्ञा, तेजः and वीर्यम् are all explicitly named benefits.

35. (D) तेजः = radiance/brilliance (how one shines), वीर्यम् = vigour/valour (active strength). Neither means wisdom (प्रज्ञा) or wealth (धनम्), neither means fear or laziness, and they are distinct, not identical.

36. (B) In a समास the members fuse and the first (सूर्य) loses its independent case ending, the whole then declining as one word (सूर्यनमस्कारः). Keeping both endings would make it two words, not a compound; it is a noun, not a verb; and it is a single word, not a sentence.

37. (A) In a compound only the final member takes the case ending for the whole word, so -ः sits on नमस्कार and marks सूर्यनमस्कारः as nominative singular; सूर्य has dropped its ending.

The first member does not keep an ending, both do not decline separately, and there is no verb inside.

38. (B) नमस्कार ('salutation', cognate with नमः) governs the dative, so 'salutation to the Sun' is सूर्याय नमस्कारः. There is no rule that the first word is dative, नमस्कारः here is nominative (not dative), and many cases can follow a noun.

39. (A) सूर्यनमस्कारः, as one fused word, names the practice/discipline; सूर्याय नमस्कारः, two words, expresses the act of saluting the Sun. They are not identical, the compound is perfectly correct Sanskrit, and the roles are not reversed.

40. (A) In forming a समास the first member loses its case ending, so the correct compound is सूर्यनमस्कारः, not सूर्यायनमस्कारः. Members do not keep their endings inside a compound, compounds are very common in Sanskrit, and endings are not relocated to the front.

41. (B) In a compound the first member drops its case ending and appears in its bare stem रवि, giving रविनमस्कारः. स्वये (dative), रविः (nominative) and रवेः (genitive) all wrongly keep a case ending inside the compound.

42. (C) आचार्या (ending -आ) is a female teacher and आचार्यः (ending -ः) a male teacher — a gender contrast. It is not singular vs plural, not a case contrast (both are nominative singular), and both are nouns, not verbs.

43. (A) आचार्या is the feminine form, so the teacher is a woman. It is not the masculine आचार्यः (a man), not plural (a group), and आचार्या still means 'teacher', not 'student'.

44. (B) आचार्या→आचार्यः flips the form from feminine to masculine, so the teacher reads as male. It does not make the word plural, does not convert prose to mantras, and is not a no-op — the gender genuinely changes.

45. (D) The feminine आ-stem आचार्या has dative singular आचार्यायै, which नमः requires. आचार्याय is the masculine dative ('to the male teacher'), आचार्या is feminine nominative, and आचार्याम् is accusative — none is the feminine dative needed.

46. (D) नमः, स्वाहा and स्वस्ति belong to a small group of indeclinables that idiomatically take a dative object. They are not verbs, they do not strip endings off following words, and they differ in meaning (salutation / oblation cry / well-being).

47. (B) स्वस्ति governs the dative, and the dative plural of प्रजा is प्रजाभ्यः, so 'well-being to the people' is स्वस्ति प्रजाभ्यः. प्रजाः is nominative, प्रजानाम् genitive, and प्रजाभिः instrumental — none is the dative स्वस्ति needs.

48. (C) स्वाहा takes a dative object; अग्नये is the dative singular of the i-stem अग्नि ('to Agni'). It is not the nominative (अग्निः), स्वाहा is an indeclinable not a dative, and the case here is dative, not accusative.

49. (A) Dative endings depend on the stem: अ-stems take -आय (मित्राय, छात्राय) and the इ-stem रवि takes -ये (रवये). All three ARE datives, just of different stem-types; -ये is not a misprint.

50. (D) देव is an अ-stem like मित्र/छात्र/सूर्य, so its dative singular is देवाय (ending -आय). देवः is nominative, देवेन instrumental, and देवस्य genitive.

51. (C) Drilling छात्राय first teaches the dative -आय ending, so the learner sees why नमः takes मित्राय. छात्र ('student') is not a Sun-name, mantras are not 'written in a paradigm', and नमः can salute any noun, not only छात्र.

52. (A) The -आय in मित्राय is the dative case-ending of the noun, making मित्राय 'to (the Sun) Mitra'; it is not the verb 'come'. मित्राय is a noun, not a verb, and नमः means 'salutation', not 'come'.

53. (B) Both halves must be right: नमः→dative→मित्राय, and सूर्यनमस्कारः is one compound. The first option errs on the case (nominative) and the compound; the second errs by calling the compound two words; the third errs on the case (accusative).

54. (D) एकार्थकशब्दाः are synonyms (one meaning, as with the Sun-names). समास is a compound (fused, not separate), चतुर्थी (dative) means 'to/for' (not 'from', which is ablative), and आचार्या is a FEMALE teacher.

55. (A) There is one Sun; सूर्याय नमः is the act 'salutation to the Sun', and सूर्यनमस्कारः is the named practice. There are not two suns, the compound does not multiply the Sun, and both expressions are perfectly grammatical.

56. (D) The chapter combines twelve postures, each with a dative Sun-name mantra (मित्राय नमः etc.), and lists the fruits स्वस्थं शरीरम्, वीर्यम्, तेजः, प्रज्ञा. It is not one repeated mantra, not moon-worship for wealth, and not a pot-saying.

57. (C) Pairing postures with meaningful dative mantras shows body and language being trained together, so health and learning advance jointly. Grammar is not kept separate here, the words' meaning is central (they salute the Sun), and the mantras are substantive, not decorative.

58. (D) All three claims are wrong and must each be fixed: नमः→dative (मित्राय), मित्र→a Sun-name (not the moon), सूर्यनमस्कारः→one compound (not two words). The distractors leave at least one error uncorrected, and the sentence is not already correct.

59. (B) नमः needs the dative. आदित्य is an अ-stem → आदित्याय; भानु is a उ-stem → भानवे. So आदित्याय नमः and भानवे नमः. The nominatives (आदित्यः, भानुः) and accusatives (आदित्यम्, भानुम्) are wrong cases, and the last option leaves भानुः in the nominative.

60. (A) The valid chain: नमः ('salutation') governs the dative; मित्र (a Sun-name) therefore becomes मित्राय; the phrase is 'salutation to the Sun'. The first chain wrongly makes a dative the subject; the second wrongly calls a two-word phrase a compound; the third misidentifies मित्र as the moon and मित्राय as instrumental.